TCS NQT 2027 · FIRST ATTEMPT PLAN

The 90 Day Roadmap to TCS NQT

One book: the 90-day plan, a topic checklist with priorities, and a syllabus playbook for every section, each followed by its strategy. Foundation and Advanced, covering Numerical, Reasoning, Verbal, Advanced Quant and Advanced Coding.

Foundation	Build	Sharpen	Final Sprint
Days 1–30	Days 31–60	Days 61–80	Days 81–90

Practise with us: Online Learning Mock Test Series: topic-wise timed practice, section tests and full-length 190-minute NQT mocks.

How to use this roadmap

Four phases, one goal: a first-attempt TCS NQT clear. Follow the order, do not skip the checkpoints.

🎯 Target

Foundation: clear every section comfortably. Advanced: 9–10 right in Quant + Reasoning and 2 coding problems (at least the Easy fully).

⏱ Daily time

Weekdays 3 hours, weekends 5 hours. With less time, extend the plan rather than skipping sections.

📓 Two notebooks

A formula notebook and an error log. Every wrong question goes in the error log with the reason.

PHASE 1

Foundation

Days 1–30

Build the base. Learn every basic concept, formulas and a coding language, with no pressure on speed yet.

- Finish all basic Numerical and Reasoning topics
- Pick ONE coding language (C++, Java or Python) and master the basics
- Start a daily 15-minute grammar and vocabulary habit
- Make a formula notebook and an error log from day 1

★ Checkpoint Test 1 on Day 30

PHASE 2

Build

Days 31–60

Go deeper. Cover the rest of the syllabus, including the Advanced Quant and Reasoning topics and intermediate coding.

- Complete the remaining aptitude topics and all DI and puzzle sets
- Cover sorting, hashing, recursion, stack and queue in code
- Start Passage Recall and Email Writing practice
- Move from untimed to timed practice

★ Checkpoint Test 2 on Day 60

PHASE 3

Sharpen

Days 61–80

Speed and accuracy. Section-wise timed tests, Medium coding problems, and a weekly full mock.

- Solve Medium coding problems with DP, greedy and graphs basics
- Do sectional tests under the exact TCS timers
- Attempt 1 full mock per week, then 2
- Fix weak topics from your error log

★ Full mocks on Days 70, 75 and 80

PHASE 4

Final Sprint

Days 81–90

Exam simulation. Full-length 190-minute mocks, revision of formulas and templates, and exam-day readiness.

- Full 190-minute mocks every second day
- Revise formula notebook, error log and code templates
- Light practice only in the last 2 days
- Prepare documents, device, internet and sleep schedule

★ Final mock on Day 88

Exam at a glance

Foundation 75 min (Numerical 20 Qs, Reasoning 20 Qs, Verbal 25 + tasks) · Advanced 115 min (Quant + Reasoning 14 Qs in 25 min, Coding 2 problems in 90 min) · Total 190 min · No negative marking · No section switching · Question switching allowed inside a section.

Your daily routine

A repeatable schedule that covers all four areas every week.

Block	Weekday (3 hrs)	Weekend (5 hrs)	What to do
Aptitude	60 min	90 min	One Numerical topic + one Reasoning topic. Concept, then 15–20 questions.
Coding	75 min	120 min	One concept, then 2–3 problems. Write the code yourself, no copying.
Verbal	20 min	30 min	Grammar, vocabulary, then recall and email drills from week 6.
Review	25 min	60 min	Update the error log and formula notebook. Revise yesterday's topic.

Weekly rhythm

- **Mon–Thu:** new topics + practice
- **Fri:** mixed timed set from the week
- **Sat:** sectional test + error analysis
- **Sun:** revision, weak topics, light coding

Mock and test calendar

- **Day 15:** aptitude quiz
- **Day 30:** Checkpoint Test 1
- **Day 45:** sectional tests (all sections)
- **Day 60:** Checkpoint Test 2
- **Days 70, 75, 80:** full mocks
- **Days 82, 84, 86, 88:** full 190-min mocks
- **Day 90:** rest and light revision

Practise with the Online Learning Mock Test Series

Every checkpoint and mock in this roadmap is available on our platform: topic-wise tests with timers, sectional tests, and full-length mocks that follow the NQT pattern. Each test gives you analysis of accuracy, time and weak topics.

How to analyse every test

- Write each wrong question in the error log: topic, why you missed it (concept, calculation, time, careless).
- Mark the questions that took over 2 minutes. Learn a faster method for each.
- Redo the wrong questions after 3 days and after 10 days.
- Track three numbers per section: attempts, accuracy and time used.

Week-by-week plan

13 weeks = 90 days. Each week, finish the listed topics before moving on.

Wk	Theme	Numerical	Reasoning	Coding	Verbal
1	**Basics begin**	Number System, LCM & HCF, Percentages	Series, Coding–Decoding	Syntax, I/O, loops, patterns	Tenses, subject–verb agreement
2	**Core arithmetic**	Profit & Loss, Ratio, Averages	Blood Relations, Directions	Arrays: traversal, min/max, rotation	Articles, prepositions
3	**Speed topics**	Time-Speed-Distance, Time & Work	Seating Arrangements, Syllogisms	Strings: palindrome, anagram, frequency	Conjunctions, pronouns
4	**Wrap-up + test**	SI & CI, Ages, Mixtures	Analogies, Odd One Out, Ranking, Clock & Calendar	Math: prime, GCD, Fibonacci, digits	Timed sentence completion. Checkpoint Test 1
5	**Counting & geometry**	P & C, Probability, Mensuration	Alphabet Test, Symbol Operations, Inequality	Sorting and binary search	Vocabulary, idioms and phrases
6	**Advanced starts**	Data Interpretation, Set Theory & Venn	Advanced seating and puzzles	Two pointers, sliding window, hashing	Passage Recall practice begins
7	**Advanced logic**	Data Sufficiency, Advanced Probability	Critical Reasoning, Syllogisms (adv.)	Recursion and backtracking basics	Email Writing: formats and templates
8	**Advanced wrap + test**	Advanced P&C, Partnership	Analytical puzzles (truth/liar, scheduling)	Stack, queue, linked list. Checkpoint	Mixed verbal drill. Checkpoint Test 2
9	**Speed phase**	Full Numerical revision, shortcuts	Full Reasoning revision, timed sets	Greedy and DP introduction (Medium)	Sentence completion at 25 s each
10	**Advanced mastery**	Advanced Quant + Reasoning timed sets	DI and puzzle sets under 25 min	DP, bit manipulation, trees and graphs basics	Passage Recall + Email speed work
11	**Mock phase**	Weak-topic repair from error log	Weak-topic repair	Medium coding in 55 min, Easy in 35 min	Full mocks on Days 70, 75
12	**Mock phase**	Sectional tests, 2 per week	Sectional tests	2 coding problems in 90 min daily	Full mock on Day 80
13	**Final sprint**	Formula and shortcut revision	Pattern revision	Code templates, edge-case checklist	Full mocks Days 82, 84, 86, 88. Rest on Day 90

Week 13 covers Days 85–90. Weeks 1–12 cover Days 1–84.

Topic checklist: all 5 sections

Start with the gold must-do topics. Tick **L** when learned, **P** when practised (20+ questions) and **M** when done in a timed mock.

● Must-do ● Important ● Good to know **L** Learned · **P** Practised · **M** Mock done

Topic	L	P	M
S1 Numerical Ability (20 Q | 25 min)			
● Percentages	☐	☐	☐
● Profit & Loss	☐	☐	☐
● Time, Speed & Distance	☐	☐	☐
● Time & Work	☐	☐	☐
● Ratio & Proportion	☐	☐	☐
● Number System	☐	☐	☐
● Averages	☐	☐	☐
● LCM & HCF	☐	☐	☐
● SI & CI	☐	☐	☐
● Probability	☐	☐	☐
● Permutation & Combination	☐	☐	☐
● Mensuration	☐	☐	☐
● Mixtures & Alligation	☐	☐	☐
● Ages, Simplification, Approximation	☐	☐	☐
S2 Reasoning Ability (20 Q | 25 min)			
● Series (number and alphabet)	☐	☐	☐
● Coding – Decoding	☐	☐	☐
● Seating Arrangements	☐	☐	☐
● Syllogisms	☐	☐	☐
● Blood Relations	☐	☐	☐
● Directions & Distances	☐	☐	☐
● Clock & Calendar	☐	☐	☐
● Ranking & Ordering	☐	☐	☐
● Alphabet Test & Symbol Operations	☐	☐	☐
● Analogies & Odd One Out	☐	☐	☐

Topic	L	P	M
S3 Verbal Ability (25 + tasks Q | 25 min)			
● Sentence Completion: grammar	☐	☐	☐
● Passage Recall	☐	☐	☐
● Email Writing	☐	☐	☐
● Sentence Completion: vocabulary	☐	☐	☐
● Idioms, Phrases & Usage	☐	☐	☐
● Error Spotting & Parallelism	☐	☐	☐
● Typing Speed & Accuracy	☐	☐	☐
● Instruction Screens	☐	☐	☐
S4 Advanced Quant + Reasoning (14 Q | 25 min)			
● Data Interpretation	☐	☐	☐
● Analytical Puzzles	☐	☐	☐
● Data Sufficiency	☐	☐	☐
● Permutation & Combination (Adv.)	☐	☐	☐
● Set Theory & Venn Diagrams	☐	☐	☐
● Advanced Probability	☐	☐	☐
● Partnership	☐	☐	☐
● Critical Reasoning	☐	☐	☐
● Syllogisms (Advanced)	☐	☐	☐
S5 Advanced Coding (2 Q | 90 min)			
● Arrays	☐	☐	☐
● Strings	☐	☐	☐
● Math & Number Theory	☐	☐	☐
● Sorting & Searching	☐	☐	☐
● Programming Fundamentals	☐	☐	☐
● Hashing, Sets & Maps	☐	☐	☐
● Greedy & Dynamic Programming	☐	☐	☐
● Two Pointers & Sliding Window	☐	☐	☐
● Recursion & Backtracking	☐	☐	☐
● Stack & Queue	☐	☐	☐
● Matrix / 2D Arrays	☐	☐	☐
● Simulation & Real-world Problems	☐	☐	☐
● Linked List, Trees & Graphs	☐	☐	☐
● Bit Manipulation	☐	☐	☐

Priority is our preparation guidance. TCS does not publish topic weightage.

01 Numerical Ability

SECTION 1 OF 5 · PART A · FOUNDATION

20	25 min	1 min 15 s	15 of 20	No
Questions	Time	Per question	Target correct	Negative marking

Official syllabus: Number System | LCM & HCF | Percentages | Profit & Loss | Time, Speed & Distance | Time & Work | SI & CI | Averages | Ratio & Proportion | Probability | P & C | Mensuration | Ages | Mixtures

Topics and what to master

1	**Percentages**	Must-do	Fraction-to-percentage table, successive change, population and salary problems. Convert to fractions to calculate faster.
2	**Profit & Loss**	Must-do	CP, SP, MP, discount, successive discounts and false weights. Always take the percentage on the right base.
3	**Time, Speed & Distance**	Must-do	Average and relative speed, trains, boats and streams, races, meeting and chasing problems. Keep units consistent.
4	**Time & Work**	Must-do	Efficiency and total-work method, pipes and cisterns, alternate days, work and wages.
5	**Ratio & Proportion**	Must-do	Dividing amounts, compound ratio, direct and inverse proportion, partnership basics.
6	**Number System**	Must-do	Divisibility, remainders, unit digits, number of factors, base conversion and trailing zeros.
7	**Averages**	Important	Weighted average, change in average on adding or removing a value, age-based averages.
8	**LCM & HCF**	Important	Prime factorisation, bells ringing together, greatest number with a given remainder.
9	**SI & CI**	Important	SI and CI formulas, half-yearly and quarterly, difference between CI and SI for 2 and 3 years.
10	**Probability**	Important	Coins, dice, cards and bags; at least and at most; independent events.
11	**Permutation & Combination**	Important	nPr, nCr, arrangements with repetition, word rank, restricted selection.
12	**Mensuration**	Important	Area and perimeter of 2D shapes; volume and surface area of cube, cuboid, cylinder, cone and sphere.
13	**Mixtures & Alligation**	Important	Alligation rule, replacement of liquid, cost of mixtures.
14	**Ages, Simplification, Approximation**	Good to know	Age equations and ratios, BODMAS, squares and cubes, quick approximation.

Must-know rules

- Learn squares to 30, cubes to 15, tables to 20 and common fractions as percentages (1/7 = 14.28%).
- Successive percentage change: a + b + ab/100.
- Speed in km/h to m/s: multiply by 5/18. Reverse: multiply by 18/5.
- Work done = efficiency x time. Take LCM of days as total work.
- Profit% = (SP − CP)/CP x 100, always on cost price unless stated.

Common traps

- Taking percentage on the wrong base (CP vs SP, old vs new value).
- Forgetting to convert minutes to hours in speed questions.
- Spending over 2 minutes on one question. Skip and return.
- Rounding too early in TITA (typed answer) questions.
- Leaving questions blank. There is no negative marking.

Numerical Ability: 90-day strategy

Day-by-day plan, exam tactics and score milestones for this section.

Numerical Ability

20 Qs · 25 min · ~75 s each

Accuracy first, speed second. Many questions are formula-based, so recall speed wins marks.

90-day plan for this section

- Days 1–30: learn concepts, write formulas in a notebook, solve 15–20 questions daily by topic.
- Days 31–60: timed topic sets (10 questions in 12 minutes), practise TITA style (type the exact answer).
- Days 61–90: sectional tests of 20 questions in 25 minutes, then review every wrong answer.

Strategy and exam tactics

- Do the easy question types first (percentages, averages, profit and loss, ratio). Leave long calculations for the end.
- Skip any question that takes over 2 minutes and mark it for return. Question switching is allowed inside a section.
- No negative marking, so never leave a blank. Make an informed guess in the last minute.
- Learn tables up to 20, squares up to 30, cubes up to 15 and common fractions to percentages.

Common mistakes: Spending 4 minutes on one hard problem · Calculation errors under pressure · Ignoring units and rounding in TITA questions

Learning order

Percentages → Profit & Loss → Ratio and Averages → TSD → Time & Work → Number System → LCM/HCF → SI & CI → P&C and Probability → Mensuration → Ages and Mixtures

Daily target

20 new questions + 10 revision questions daily. Weekly: 1 sectional test of 20 Qs in 25 min.

Self-check questions

- How do I find the unit digit of a large power quickly?
- Can I convert any fraction to a percentage in 5 seconds?
- Do I know relative speed formulas for trains and boats?
- Can I solve a 3-person work problem using efficiency?

Score milestones (track these on the Online Learning Mock Test Series)

Checkpoint	Target accuracy	Target speed	If you miss it
Day 30	60%	40 min per 20 Qs	Re-learn concepts of the weakest 3 topics
Day 60	75%	30 min per 20 Qs	Add 20 timed questions daily on weak topics
Day 90	85%+	25 min per 20 Qs	Skip-and-return strategy, guess in last 2 min

02

SECTION 2 OF 5 · PART A · FOUNDATION

Reasoning Ability

20	25 min	1 min 15 s	16 of 20	No
Questions	Time	Per question	Target correct	Negative marking

Official syllabus: Series | Coding – Decoding | Blood Relations | Directions | Seating Arrangements | Syllogisms | Analogies | Odd One Out | Clock & Calendar | Ranking | Alphabet Test | Symbol Operations

Topics and what to master

1	**Series (number and alphabet)**	Must-do	Arithmetic, geometric, square, cube, alternating and mixed series; missing and wrong term; letter positions.
2	**Coding – Decoding**	Must-do	Letter shifts, reverse alphabet, number and symbol codes, conditional and mixed coding.
3	**Seating Arrangements**	Must-do	Linear (one and two rows), circular and square tables. Draw the layout first and place definite clues before conditional ones.
4	**Syllogisms**	Must-do	All, Some, No and Some-not; Venn diagrams; definite vs possibility; either-or conclusions.
5	**Blood Relations**	Must-do	Family trees with gender marks, coded relations, pointing to a photograph.
6	**Directions & Distances**	Important	Net displacement with Pythagoras, left and right turns, shadow-based directions.
7	**Clock & Calendar**	Important	Angle between hands, overlaps, gain and loss, day of the week using odd days, leap years.
8	**Ranking & Ordering**	Important	Position from left and right, total persons = rank from top + rank from bottom − 1, interchange of positions.
9	**Alphabet Test & Symbol Operations**	Important	Alphabet positions, meaningful words, letter counting, redefined operators and coded inequalities.
10	**Analogies & Odd One Out**	Good to know	Word, number and letter analogies; classification. Quick marks if you know the patterns.

Must-know rules

- Positions: A=1 … Z=26, and opposite letter pairs add to 27.
- Total persons in a row = position from left + position from right − 1.
- Venn diagram for every syllogism, never intuition.
- Clock: angle = $|30H - 5.5M|$. Hands overlap 11 times in 12 hours.
- Odd days: ordinary year 1, leap year 2, century 0 or 1 (400 years = 0).

Common traps

- Mixing left and right in direction and seating questions.
- Treating 'some' as 'all' in syllogisms.
- Starting a puzzle set without a table or diagram.
- Missing the word 'definitely' in conclusions.
- Forgetting that facing direction flips left and right in circular seating.

Reasoning Ability: 90-day strategy

Day-by-day plan, exam tactics and score milestones for this section.

Reasoning Ability

20 Qs · 25 min · ~75 s each

Pattern recognition and clean diagrams. Practice makes this the most scoring Foundation section.

90-day plan for this section

- Days 1–30: series, coding-decoding, blood relations, directions, seating basics.
- Days 31–60: puzzles, syllogisms with Venn diagrams, clock and calendar, inequality.
- Days 61–90: timed sets of 20 in 25 minutes. Aim for 85%+ accuracy.

Strategy and exam tactics

- For puzzle sets, draw a table first. One set gives 3–5 questions, so it is worth the setup time.
- Solve series and coding-decoding in under 40 seconds each. They are the quickest marks.
- For syllogisms, use Venn diagrams every time, never intuition.
- Read all conditions before placing anything in a seating arrangement.

Common mistakes: Rushing the setup of a puzzle · Mixing left and right in direction questions · Missing the word 'definitely' in syllogism conclusions

Learning order

Series → Coding-Decoding → Blood Relations → Directions → Seating → Syllogisms → Clock & Calendar → Ranking → Alphabet Test → Symbol Operations → Analogies

Daily target

15 questions + 1 puzzle set daily. Weekly: 1 sectional test of 20 Qs in 25 min.

Self-check questions

- Can I draw a Venn diagram for any syllogism in 30 seconds?
- Can I find the day of any date quickly using odd days?
- Can I set up a circular seating table without errors?
- Can I decode letter shifts without writing every letter?

Score milestones (track these on the Online Learning Mock Test Series)

Checkpoint	Target accuracy	Target speed	If you miss it
Day 30	65%	35 min per 20 Qs	Redo series, coding and relations daily
Day 60	80%	28 min per 20 Qs	Practise 2 puzzle sets daily
Day 90	90%	25 min per 20 Qs	Timed sectional every alternate day

03 Verbal Ability

SECTION 3 OF 5 · PART A · FOUNDATION (UPDATED 2027 PATTERN)

25+	25 min	25 s	9 min	3
Items + tasks	Time	Per sentence	Email writing	Task types

Official syllabus: Sentence Completion (20 items, 25 s each) | Passage Recall (4 + 4, 30 s read + 90 s write) | Email Writing (1, 9 min) | Instruction screens

Topics and what to master

1	**Sentence Completion: grammar**	Must-do	Tenses, subject-verb agreement, articles, prepositions, pronouns, conjunctions. Eliminate wrong options in seconds.
2	**Passage Recall**	Must-do	The passage disappears after 30 seconds. Note names, numbers and order of events, then rebuild in short clear sentences within 90 seconds.
3	**Email Writing**	Must-do	Subject, greeting, purpose, details, action, closing. Practise request, complaint, apology and follow-up emails in 9 minutes.
4	**Sentence Completion: vocabulary**	Important	Synonyms, antonyms, word choice and collocations. Learn 10 words daily.
5	**Idioms, Phrases & Usage**	Important	Common idioms, phrasal verbs, confusing word pairs.
6	**Error Spotting & Parallelism**	Important	Sentence structure, modifiers, parallel construction.
7	**Typing Speed & Accuracy**	Important	Recall and email are typed. Aim for 30+ words per minute with few errors.
8	**Instruction Screens**	Good to know	Short timed screens (25 s and 15 s). Read fast; the timer keeps running.

Must-know rules

- Each item has its own timer: 25 s for each sentence, 120 s for each recall task, 540 s for the email.
- Subject-verb agreement: find the true subject, ignore words in between.
- Email structure: Subject → Greeting → Purpose → Details → Action → Closing.
- In recall, write facts (who, what, when, number) first, then connect them.
- Check spelling and punctuation before the email timer ends.

Common traps

- Spending 40 s on one sentence-completion item.
- Trying to memorise the passage word for word.
- Writing a long email and running out of time.
- Informal tone or text-style spelling in emails.
- Slow typing that wastes the 90 s recall window.

Verbal Ability: 90-day strategy

Day-by-day plan, exam tactics and score milestones for this section.

Verbal Ability (2027 pattern)

25 + tasks · 25 min · timed per item

Three task types with hard per-question timers: Sentence Completion, Passage Recall and Email Writing.

90-day plan for this section

- Days 1–30: grammar rules (tenses, agreement, articles, prepositions) and 10 new words daily.
- Days 31–60: idioms and phrases, Passage Recall practice (30 s read, 90 s write) and email formats.
- Days 61–90: practise the full flow with timers: 20 sentences at 25 s each, 4+4 recall tasks, one 9-minute email.

Strategy and exam tactics

- Sentence Completion: eliminate grammatically wrong options first. 25 seconds means no time to re-read twice.
- Passage Recall: note names, numbers and the order of events. Reconstruct short, clear sentences.
- Email Writing: use a fixed structure: subject, greeting, purpose, details, action, closing. Keep it under 150 words and check spelling.
- Improve typing speed. Even a good memory fails if typing is slow.

Common mistakes: Writing long emails and running out of time · Grammar errors in the email · Not practising typing

Learning order

Tenses and agreement → Articles and prepositions → Vocabulary and idioms → Sentence completion speed → Passage Recall → Email Writing → Full flow with timers

Daily target

20 sentence-completion questions, 1 recall task and 1 email (from week 6) daily.

Self-check questions

- Can I choose the right tense in under 10 seconds?
- Can I recall names, numbers and order from a 30 s passage?
- Do I have 4 email templates (request, complaint, apology, follow-up)?
- Is my typing speed above 30 words per minute?

Score milestones (track these on the Online Learning Mock Test Series)

Checkpoint	Target accuracy	Target speed	If you miss it
Day 30	70% grammar	40 s per sentence	Revise grammar rules, 10 words daily
Day 60	80% grammar	30 s per sentence	Daily 4 recall tasks and 1 email
Day 90	85%+	25 s per sentence, email in 9 min	Full verbal flow with timers every day

04

SECTION 4 OF 5 · PART B · ADVANCED

Advanced Quant + Reasoning

14	25 min	1 min 47 s	9–10 of 14	No
Questions	Time	Per question	Target correct	Negative marking

Official syllabus: Data Interpretation | Set Theory & Venn Diagrams | Data Sufficiency | Syllogisms | Advanced Probability | Permutation & Combination | Partnership | Critical Reasoning | Analytical Puzzles

Topics and what to master

1	**Data Interpretation**	Must-do	Tables, bar, line, pie and mixed charts. Percentage change, share of total, ratios and averages. Approximate to save time.
2	**Analytical Puzzles**	Must-do	Multi-variable arrangement, scheduling, truth-and-liar and grouping puzzles. Build a table first.
3	**Data Sufficiency**	Must-do	Check Statement I alone, then II alone, then both together. Decide sufficiency, do not solve fully.
4	**Permutation & Combination (Adv.)**	Must-do	Restricted arrangements, distribution of objects, circular and digit-formation problems.
5	**Set Theory & Venn Diagrams**	Important	Two and three sets, only/exactly/at least counts, maximum and minimum overlap.
6	**Advanced Probability**	Important	Conditional probability, with and without replacement, arrangement-based probability.
7	**Partnership**	Important	Investment x time, entry and exit of partners, working partner with salary.
8	**Critical Reasoning**	Important	Assumption, inference, strengthen and weaken, course of action.
9	**Syllogisms (Advanced)**	Good to know	3–4 statement sets with possibility cases, solved with Venn diagrams.

Must-know rules

- Two sets: $n(A \cup B) = n(A) + n(B) - n(A \cap B)$.
- Three sets: add singles, subtract pairs, add the triple intersection.
- Data sufficiency order: I alone → II alone → both → neither.
- Approximate in DI: 48.7% of 623 ≈ 50% of 620.
- Start with the question group that has the most questions (a DI set or puzzle).

Common traps

- Solving the whole DI set before reading the questions.
- Calculating exactly when an approximation is enough.
- Getting stuck on one puzzle for over 4 minutes.
- Using both statements before testing each alone.
- Chasing all 14 questions instead of securing 9–10.

Advanced Quant + Reasoning: 90-day strategy

Day-by-day plan, exam tactics and score milestones for this section.

Advanced Quant + Reasoning

14 Qs · 25 min · ~107 s each

Harder and multi-step. Smart selection of questions matters more than attempting everything in order.

90-day plan for this section

- Days 31–60: learn DI, Venn diagrams, data sufficiency, advanced probability and P&C.
- Days 61–80: timed sets of 14 in 25 minutes. Practise choosing the easiest 8–9 first.
- Days 81–90: full-section simulations inside full mocks.

Strategy and exam tactics

- Start with data-set and puzzle questions, since one set can carry several questions.
- For DI, estimate and approximate instead of exact calculation.
- Data sufficiency: test each statement alone, then together, in that order.
- Target 9–10 correct answers, which is a safe score. Do not chase all 14.

Common mistakes: Reading a full DI set before checking the questions · Over-calculating instead of approximating · Staying stuck on one puzzle

Learning order

Data Interpretation → Set Theory and Venn → Data Sufficiency → Puzzles → Advanced P&C → Advanced Probability → Partnership → Critical Reasoning

Daily target

1 DI set, 1 puzzle set and 3 advanced questions daily. Weekly: 1 timed section of 14 Qs in 25 min.

Self-check questions

- Can I finish a DI set in 6 minutes using approximation?
- Can I solve a 3-circle Venn problem with formulas?
- Can I judge data sufficiency without calculating the full answer?
- Can I spot the strengthening or weakening choice in critical reasoning?

Score milestones (track these on the Online Learning Mock Test Series)

Checkpoint	Target accuracy	Target speed	If you miss it
Day 30	Concepts only	Untimed	Finish basic Numerical and Reasoning first
Day 60	6 of 14	35 min	Revise DI, Venn and data sufficiency
Day 90	9–10 of 14	25 min	Choose questions smartly, approximate in DI

05 Advanced Coding

SECTION 5 OF 5 · PART B · ADVANCED

2	90 min	35 + 55	5	Hidden
Problems	Time	Easy + Medium (min)	Languages	Test cases

Official syllabus: Languages: C | C++ | Java | Python | Perl. Problem types: arrays | strings | math | sorting | recursion | DP and more. Scoring is by hidden test cases.

Topics and what to master

1	**Arrays**	Must-do	Traversal, rotation, prefix sums, Kadane, duplicates and missing numbers, rearrangement, frequency counting.
2	**Strings**	Must-do	Palindromes, anagrams, frequency, substrings, compression, reverse words, pattern matching.
3	**Math & Number Theory**	Must-do	Prime and sieve, GCD and LCM, Fibonacci, digit problems, modular arithmetic, base conversion.
4	**Sorting & Searching**	Must-do	Core sorts, binary search and its variants, custom comparators, k-th element.
5	**Programming Fundamentals**	Must-do	Input and output formats, multiple test cases, loops, patterns, data types and overflow.
6	**Hashing, Sets & Maps**	Must-do	Two-sum, group anagrams, first non-repeating element, subarray sum equals K.
7	**Greedy & Dynamic Programming**	Must-do	Coin change, knapsack, LIS, LCS, grid paths, subset sum. Usually the Medium problem.
8	**Two Pointers & Sliding Window**	Important	Pair sum, longest unique substring, fixed and variable windows.
9	**Recursion & Backtracking**	Important	Subsets, permutations, N-Queens, combination sum, maze paths.
10	**Stack & Queue**	Important	Balanced parentheses, next greater element, expression evaluation.
11	**Matrix / 2D Arrays**	Important	Spiral and diagonal traversal, rotation, transpose, search in sorted matrix.
12	**Simulation & Real-world Problems**	Important	Date and time, billing and parking logic, grid movement, scheduling.
13	**Linked List, Trees & Graphs**	Good to know	Reverse list, cycle detection, tree traversals, BFS and DFS basics.
14	**Bit Manipulation**	Good to know	Set bits, power of two, XOR tricks, toggling bits.

Must-know rules

- n up to 10^5 needs about O(n log n) or better. n up to 10^3 can use $O(n^2)$.
- Write a brute-force solution first so you have partial marks, then optimise.
- Use 64-bit integers (long long, long) when sums or products can be large.
- Always test: empty input, one element, all equal, maximum size, negatives.
- Solve the Easy problem fully in about 35 minutes before the Medium.

Common traps

- Not reading constraints before choosing the approach.
- Missing multiple test cases or a wrong input and output format.
- Integer overflow and off-by-one errors.
- Spending 60 minutes on the Easy problem.
- Switching languages during preparation.

Advanced Coding: 90-day strategy

Day-by-day plan, exam tactics and score milestones for this section.

Advanced Coding

2 problems · 90 min · Easy ~35 + Medium ~55

The section that decides Digital and Prime. Judged on hidden test cases, so edge cases matter.

90-day plan for this section

- Days 1–30: one language, basics, loops, arrays, strings, math (80–100 Easy problems).
- Days 31–60: sorting, searching, hashing, two pointers, recursion, stack, queue (Easy to Medium).
- Days 61–90: Medium problems on DP, greedy, graphs basics. Solve 2 problems in 90 minutes, daily.

Strategy and exam tactics

- Read constraints first to estimate the required time complexity (n up to 10^5 means no $O(n^2)$).
- Write a brute-force solution first so you have partial marks, then optimise.
- Always test: empty input, one element, all equal elements, maximum size, negative numbers.
- Solve the Easy problem completely in about 35 minutes before starting the Medium.
- Match the input and output format exactly. Extra spaces or text can fail every test.

Common mistakes: Not handling multiple test cases · Integer overflow · Spending 60 minutes on the Easy problem

Learning order

Basics and patterns → Arrays → Strings → Math → Sorting and searching → Hashing → Two pointers → Recursion → Stack and queue → Greedy → DP → Graph and tree basics → Bit manipulation

Daily target

2 problems daily (1 Easy + 1 Easy/Medium). Weekly: 1 timed round of 2 problems in 90 min.

Self-check questions

- Can I write input parsing for multiple test cases without errors?
- Can I state the time complexity of my solution?
- Can I list five edge cases before I submit?
- Can I solve a standard DP problem (coin change, LIS) from scratch?

Score milestones (track these on the Online Learning Mock Test Series)

Checkpoint	Target accuracy	Target speed	If you miss it
Day 30	60 Easy problems	30 min per Easy	Practise one language daily, no switching
Day 60	150 Easy + 20 Medium	Easy 35 min, Medium 70 min	Revise hashing, recursion and sorting patterns
Day 90	Easy fully + most Medium tests	2 problems in 90 min	Mock coding rounds with edge-case checklist

Exam-day strategy

How to manage the 190 minutes.

Section	Time	Plan
Numerical	25 min	Pass 1 (15 min): easy and medium questions. Pass 2 (8 min): skipped ones. Last 2 min: guess the rest.
Reasoning	25 min	Series, coding and relations first. Puzzle sets next, with a table. Guess leftovers.
Verbal	25 min	Follow the timers. Sentence completion fast, recall in short facts, email in structure.
Adv. Quant + Reasoning	25 min	Pick data sets and easy questions first. Aim for 9–10 correct.
Advanced Coding	90 min	Easy: 35 min. Medium: 55 min. Brute force first, then optimise. Test edge cases.

Before the exam (checklist)

- ☐ Original Govt ID ready (original, not a photocopy)
- ☐ Admit card and exam link checked
- ☐ Stable internet, charged laptop, backup power
- ☐ Pen and rough sheets ready
- ☐ Sleep 7+ hours the night before
- ☐ Light meal, water, quiet room
- ☐ Log in 30 minutes early

Rules to remember

- No section switching: finish each section inside its own timer.
- Question switching is allowed inside a section.
- No negative marking: attempt every question.
- TITA questions need an exact typed answer.
- Each section has its own timer.

If things go wrong

- **Blank mind in Verbal:** write what you remember in short sentences. Partial text is better than none.
- **Stuck on a coding problem:** submit the brute force and move on. It can pass some test cases.
- **Time running out in aptitude:** select answers for all remaining questions.

90-day tracker

Tick each day when your daily plan is complete.

1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐	6 ☐	7 ☐	8 ☐	9 ☐	10 ☐
11 ☐	12 ☐	13 ☐	14 ☐	15 ☐	16 ☐	17 ☐	18 ☐	19 ☐	20 ☐
21 ☐	22 ☐	23 ☐	24 ☐	25 ☐	26 ☐	27 ☐	28 ☐	29 ☐	30 ☐
31 ☐	32 ☐	33 ☐	34 ☐	35 ☐	36 ☐	37 ☐	38 ☐	39 ☐	40 ☐
41 ☐	42 ☐	43 ☐	44 ☐	45 ☐	46 ☐	47 ☐	48 ☐	49 ☐	50 ☐
51 ☐	52 ☐	53 ☐	54 ☐	55 ☐	56 ☐	57 ☐	58 ☐	59 ☐	60 ☐
61 ☐	62 ☐	63 ☐	64 ☐	65 ☐	66 ☐	67 ☐	68 ☐	69 ☐	70 ☐
71 ☐	72 ☐	73 ☐	74 ☐	75 ☐	76 ☐	77 ☐	78 ☐	79 ☐	80 ☐
81 ☐	82 ☐	83 ☐	84 ☐	85 ☐	86 ☐	87 ☐	88 ☐	89 ☐	90 ☐

Checkpoints

- ☐ Day 30: Checkpoint Test 1
- ☐ Day 60: Checkpoint Test 2
- ☐ Day 70: Full mock 1
- ☐ Day 75: Full mock 2
- ☐ Day 80: Full mock 3
- ☐ Days 82, 84, 86, 88: Full mocks 4–7

Score log

Test	Num	Reas	Verb	Adv	Code

Ready to start Day 1?

Take your first topic-wise test on the Online Learning Mock Test Series and begin your 90 days today. Consistency beats intensity: 3 focused hours a day will take you further than 12 hours once a week.